

Cost and benefit: On Bangladesh, India and Sheikh Hasina

India cannot **hand over** Sheikh Hasina to the unelected Yunus government

Amidst signs that New Delhi and Dhaka are trying to **resolve** other issues that have **marred** their **ties** in the last few months, the **issue** of Bangladesh's demand that India **extradite** Sheikh Hasina **remains intractable**, with neither side **budging**. In December, Indian Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri was able to **convey** during his Dhaka visit, that India remains a friend. He also **reaffirmed** the **continuity** in ties in trade, energy, **infrastructure** and connectivity; the two sides appear to have calmed the situation at the border as well. Finally, the government indicated to a parliamentary committee that while Ms. Hasina remains in Delhi as India's guest, it **had no truck with** her political **pronouncements** and messages targeting Mr. Yunus. The situation seemed to shift last week, as Bangladesh sent New Delhi a "**note verbale**" or diplomatic **missive** demanding Ms. Hasina's **extradition** to face trial for cases that include corruption, and a Dhaka-based International Crimes Tribunal charge that she had **perpetrated** 'crimes against humanity' in ordering a police **crackdown** on student protesters. The India-Bangladesh extradition **treaty** of 2013, **amended** in 2016, **sets out** the **course** of procedures quite clearly, which needs to be **pursued** through a more formal representation from Bangladesh to India. The note verbale appears to be meant only to **assuage** domestic political constituencies, while India's External Affairs Ministry's **response** — not rejecting it **outright** — **seems** to be a **non-escalatory** way of **dealing with** the situation.

While the **legalities** of the request can be the subject of **protracted negotiations**, it is important to ensure that the issue does not hold India-Bangladesh relations **hostage**. The Yunus government must understand that the **history** of India's relationship with Ms. Hasina and her family **is forged** in the sacrifices made in both countries for the **liberation** of Bangladesh. The **assassination** of her father, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, and members of her family in 1975, and her first **exile** in India, **strengthened** the bond. It is **futile** to expect that India would simply hand Ms. Hasina over, when she has **sought refuge** here, and no amount of **coercive** pressure could force an Indian government to **comply**. The **decision** to **shelter** the Dalai Lama in 1959, for example, **has** not **wavered** despite Chinese pressure. **Furthermore, bringing** Ms. Hasina **to account** is not the **mandate** of the **interim regime**, and should be **pursued** by a government **duly** elected by the Bangladeshi people. In Delhi, there must be a **recognition** that the **actions** of Ms. Hasina's government **have scarred** the nation. **The fact** that she is making political statements with ease from Indian soil **is** likely to **embitter** ties and New Delhi must conduct a full cost-benefit analysis of how helpful these statements are. **Given** the consequences of a **tense** border and geopolitical **turmoil**, both countries must learn to deal with the issue diplomatically — **in a separate silo** from other **aspects** of their important relationship. **[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Hand over** (phrasal verb) – Surrender, transfer, deliver, relinquish, give up सौंपना
2. **Amidst** (preposition) – Among, in the middle of, surrounded by, during के बीच में
3. **Resolve** (verb) – Solve, settle, address, rectify, deal with हल करना
4. **Mar** (verb) – Damage, spoil, impair, ruin, tarnish बिगाड़ना
5. **Ties** (noun) – Relations, connections, links, bonds, associations संबंध
6. **Extradite** (verb) – Deport, hand over, surrender, transfer प्रत्यर्पित करना
7. **Intractable** (adjective) – Unmanageable, difficult, stubborn, unyielding, complex जटिल
8. **Budge** (verb) – Move, yield, shift, change, relent हिलना
9. **Convey** (verb) – Communicate, express, relay, impart, transmit व्यक्त करना
10. **Reaffirm** (verb) – Confirm, restate, assert, validate, revalidate पुनः पुष्टि करना
11. **Continuity** (noun) – Consistency, persistence, progression, flow, steadiness निरंतरता
12. **Infrastructure** (noun) – Facilities, framework, base, foundation, system आधारभूत संरचना
13. **Have no truck with** (phrase) – Avoid, not associate with, shun, disregard संबंध न रखना
14. **Pronouncement** (noun) – Declaration, statement, announcement, proclamation, verdict घोषणा
15. **Note verbale** (noun) – Diplomatic communication, formal note, official memo कूटनीतिक पत्र
16. **Missive** (noun) – a long official letter आधिकारिक पत्र
17. **Extradition** (noun) – Deportation, handover, surrender, transfer प्रत्यर्पण
18. **Perpetrate** (verb) – Commit, execute, carry out, perform, enact अंजाम देना
19. **Crackdown** (noun) – Suppression, clampdown, enforcement action, repression कार्रवाई
20. **Amend** (verb) – Modify, change, revise, adjust, alter संशोधित करना
21. **Set out** (phrasal verb) – Specify, outline, define, lay down निर्दिष्ट करना
22. **Course** (noun) – Path, direction, way, process, method मार्ग
23. **Pursue** (verb) – Follow, seek, chase, proceed, engage in पीछा करना

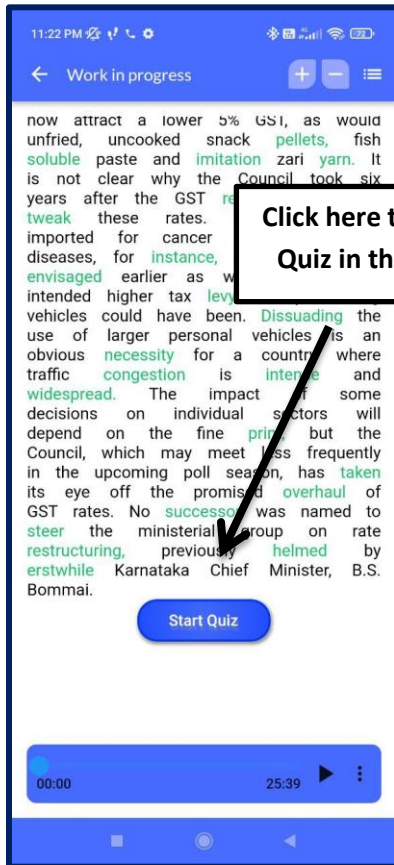
24. **Assuage** (verb) – Alleviate, ease, soothe, pacify, lessen शांत करना
25. **Outright** (adjective) – Total, complete, absolute, unqualified, definite पूर्ण
26. **Non-escalatory** (adjective) – Non-aggressive, de-escalatory, peaceful, controlled गैर-वृद्धिकारी
27. **Deal with** (phrasal verb) – Handle, manage, address, resolve निपटना
28. **Legality** (noun) – Lawfulness, legitimacy, validity, justice वैधता
29. **Protracted** (adjective) – Prolonged, extended, lengthy, drawn-out लंबा खिंचा हुआ
30. **Negotiation** (noun) – Discussion, talks, dialogue, deliberation, bargaining वार्ता
31. **Hostage** (noun) – Captive, prisoner, pawn, detainee बंधक
32. **Forge** (verb) – Build, create, establish, develop, shape बनाना
33. **Liberation** (noun) – Freedom, emancipation, release, independence स्वतंत्रता
34. **Assassination** (noun) – Murder, killing, execution, elimination हत्या
35. **Exile** (noun) – Banishment, expulsion, displacement, deportation निर्वासन
36. **Strengthen** (verb) – Fortify, reinforce, bolster, support, consolidate मजबूत करना
37. **Futile** (adjective) – Useless, pointless, ineffective, fruitless, vain व्यर्थ
38. **Seek** (verb) – Search for, pursue, aim for, look for प्रयास करना
39. **Refuge** (noun) – Shelter, asylum, sanctuary, protection शरण
40. **Coercive** (adjective) – Forceful, intimidating, oppressive, compelling जबरदस्ती करने वाला
41. **Comply** (verb) – Obey, follow, adhere, submit, conform पालन करना
42. **Shelter** (verb) – Protect, house, provide refuge, shield आश्रय देना
43. **Waver** (verb) – Hesitate, falter, vacillate, oscillate, sway डगमगाना
44. **Furthermore** (adverb) – Moreover, additionally, also, besides इसके अलावा
45. **Bring someone to account** (phrase) – Hold responsible, make answerable, call to justice जवाबदेह ठहराना
46. **Mandate** (noun) – Authority, command, directive, order आदेश
47. **Interim** (adjective) – Temporary, provisional, transitional, short-term अस्थायी

48. **Regime** (noun) – Government, administration, authority, rule शासन
49. **Duly** (adjective) – Properly, rightfully, correctly, appropriately उचित रूप से
50. **Recognition** (noun) – Acknowledgment, awareness, identification, realization पहचान
51. **Scar** (verb) – Mark, wound, harm, injure, damage चोट पहुंचाना
52. **Embitter** (verb) – Make resentful, provoke, aggravate, sour कड़वाहट पैदा करना
53. **Given** (preposition) – Considering, taking into account, in view of देखते हुए
54. **Tense** (adjective) – Strained, stressed, anxious, uneasy तनावपूर्ण
55. **Turmoil** (noun) – Chaos, unrest, confusion, upheaval, disorder उथल-पुथल
56. **In a silo** (phrase) – Isolated, separated, compartmentalized अलगाव में
57. **Aspect** (noun) – Feature, element, facet, component पहलू

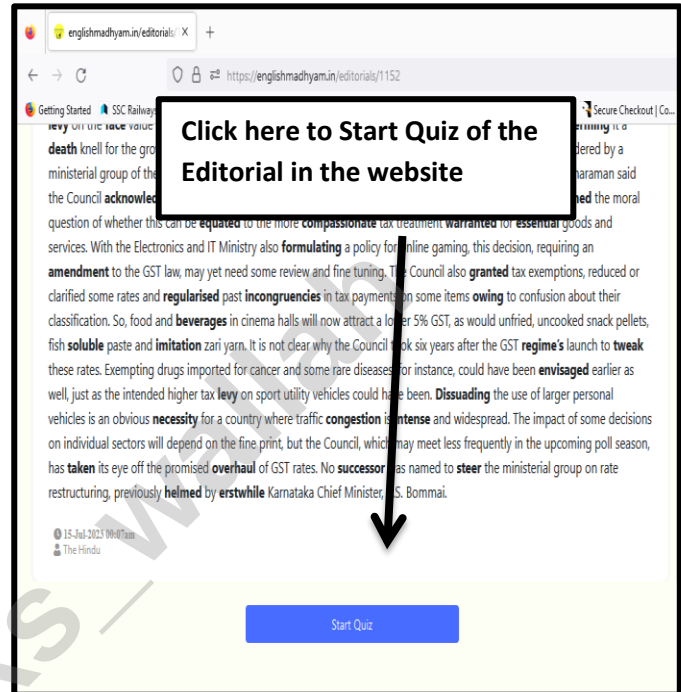
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Issue of Extradition:** India and Bangladesh are at an impasse over Bangladesh's demand for India to extradite Sheikh Hasina, with both sides standing firm.
2. **Diplomatic Engagement:** Indian Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri's December visit to Dhaka reaffirmed friendly ties, focusing on trade, energy, infrastructure, and border stability.
3. **Bangladesh's Request:** Bangladesh recently sent a diplomatic note (note verbale) demanding Sheikh Hasina's extradition for cases involving corruption and alleged crimes against humanity.
4. **India's Position:** India has avoided outright rejection of the request, opting for a non-escalatory approach to maintain diplomatic decorum.
5. **Extradition Treaty:** The India-Bangladesh extradition treaty (2013, amended in 2016) outlines the legal procedures for extradition, which Bangladesh must follow through formal channels.
6. **Domestic Politics in Bangladesh:** The note verbale is seen as a move to address domestic political concerns in Bangladesh rather than a serious legal effort.
7. **Historical Bond:** India's relationship with Sheikh Hasina and her family is rooted in the sacrifices made during Bangladesh's liberation war and her family's assassination in 1975.
8. **India's Stance on Refuge:** Like its steadfast support for the Dalai Lama despite Chinese pressure, India is unlikely to hand over Sheikh Hasina, who has sought refuge.
9. **Yunus Government's Limitations:** The interim regime in Bangladesh lacks the legitimacy to pursue such significant actions; such matters should be handled by an elected government.
10. **Political Statements by Hasina:** Sheikh Hasina's political pronouncements from Indian soil could strain India-Bangladesh relations and embitter the Yunus government.
11. **Impact on Relations:** The extradition issue must not dominate or derail broader India-Bangladesh relations, which involve significant trade and connectivity cooperation.
12. **Scarred Legacy:** Ms. Hasina's actions as Bangladesh's leader have caused internal divisions, complicating the narrative of her political asylum in India.
13. **Geopolitical Sensitivities:** A tense India-Bangladesh border or strained ties could have broader regional consequences.
14. **Diplomatic Approach Needed:** Both nations must handle the issue diplomatically and ensure it is addressed separately from other aspects of their bilateral relationship.
15. **Cost-Benefit Analysis for India:** India must weigh the benefits and risks of allowing Sheikh Hasina to continue making political statements from its soil, ensuring its actions align with long-term strategic goals.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



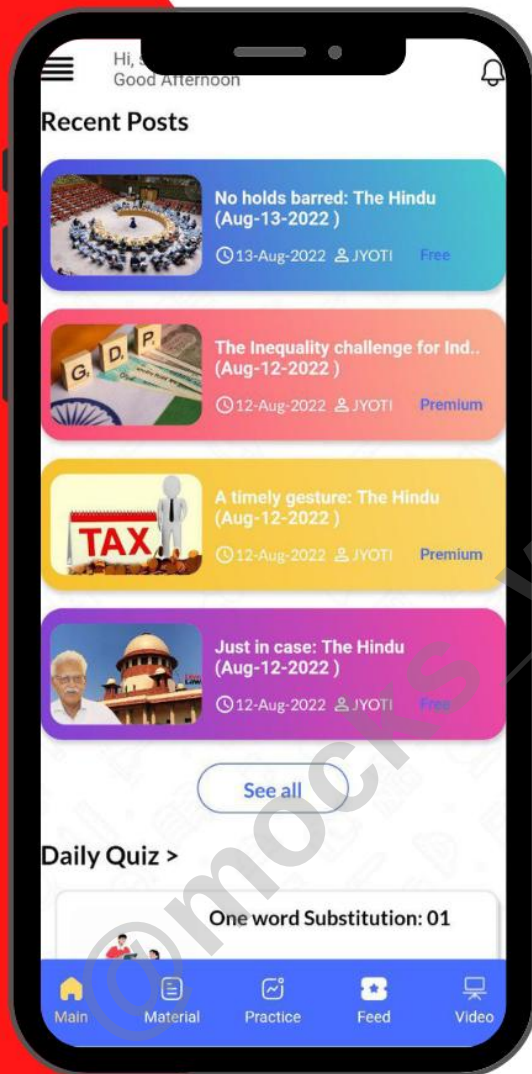
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